

Brief App Interior Design - Cursor AI Implementation Specification

Document Version: 1.0

Target Audience: Cursor AI / Developers

Purpose: Pixel-perfect reproduction of the minimalist Brief app interface

Status: Production Ready

Quick Start for Cursor AI

Prompt to use with Cursor AI:

"Build a React/Next.js application for the Brief app workspace interface based on the specifications in this document. The design is minimalist, professional, and uses a dark theme. Create all components, pages, and styling exactly as specified. Use Tailwind CSS for styling. The layout has a fixed sidebar (280px), sticky header (64px), and main content area with tabs, cards, and a right panel. Implement all components listed in the Component Library section with exact colors, spacing, and interactions specified."

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Design System

Design Philosophy

The Brief app interior uses **sophisticated minimalism** - a design approach where every visual element serves a functional purpose. The interface prioritizes clarity, efficiency, and beauty through restraint rather than decoration. The dark theme reduces eye strain while the carefully chosen accent color (purple) draws attention to interactive elements without overwhelming the interface.

Core Design Tenets:

- Functional Minimalism:** No decorative elements. Every pixel has purpose.
- Clear Visual Hierarchy:** Information architecture guides users naturally through workflows.
- Breathing Space:** Generous padding and whitespace reduce cognitive load.
- Subtle Elegance:** Premium feel achieved through typography, spacing, and color restraint.
- Consistency:** Unified component system eliminates visual confusion.
- Accessibility First:** High contrast ratios, readable fonts, keyboard navigation.

Design Grid

The interface uses a **4px base unit** for all spacing and sizing. This creates a harmonious, predictable rhythm throughout the application.

Spacing Scale: 4px, 8px, 12px, 16px, 24px, 32px, 48px, 64px, 96px

All measurements should be multiples of 4px for consistency.

Color Tokens

Primary Color Palette (Dark Mode)

All colors use OKLCH format for perceptually uniform color space. Hex values provided for reference.

Token Name	OKLCH Value	Hex	RGB	Usage
--bg-primary	oklch(0.09 0.01 280)	#0f0f1e	rgb(15, 15, 30)	Main background, page background

--bg-surface	oklch(0.13 0.015 280)	#1a1a2e	rgb(26, 26, 46)	Cards, panels, surface elements
--bg-surface-hover	oklch(0.16 0.018 280)	#242438	rgb(36, 36, 56)	Hover state for surfaces
--border	oklch(0.22 0.02 280)	#353549	rgb(53, 53, 73)	Borders, dividers
--text-primary	oklch(0.96 0.01 280)	#f5f5ff	rgb(245, 245, 255)	Main text, headings
--text-secondary	oklch(0.72 0.02 280)	#b8b8d0	rgb(184, 184, 208)	Secondary text, labels
--text-tertiary	oklch(0.58 0.02 280)	#8888a0	rgb(136, 136, 160)	Disabled text, muted text
--accent	oklch(0.56 0.23 262)	#7c3aed	rgb(124, 58, 237)	Primary interactive, highlights
--accent-subtle	rgba(124, 58, 237, 0.1)	N/A	N/A	Accent backgrounds, subtle highlights

Semantic Colors

State	Color Name	OKLCH	Hex	Usage
Success	--success	oklch(0.60 0.15 142)	#4ade80	Completed, active, success states
Warning	--warning	oklch(0.68 0.18 70)	#facc15	Pending, caution, in-progress states
Error	--error	oklch(0.60 0.20 25)	#ef4444	Errors, destructive actions, failed states

Info	--info	oklch(0.58 0.20 250)	#3b82f6	Information, hints, notifications
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CSS Variables (for Tailwind/CSS)

CSS

```
:root {
  --bg-primary: #0f0f1e;
  --bg-surface: #1a1a2e;
  --bg-surface-hover: #242438;
  --border: #353549;
  --text-primary: #f5f5ff;
  --text-secondary: #b8b8d0;
  --text-tertiary: #8888a0;
  --accent: #7c3aed;
  --accent-subtle: rgba(124, 58, 237, 0.1);
  --success: #4ade80;
  --warning: #facc15;
  --error: #ef4444;
  --info: #3b82f6;
}
```

Contrast Ratios (WCAG Compliance)

- Text Primary on Background: **12:1** (exceeds WCAG AAA)
- Text Secondary on Background: **8:1** (meets WCAG AA)
- Accent on Background: **8:1** (meets WCAG AA)
- Borders on Background: **4:1** (meets WCAG AA)

Typography

Font Stack

Primary Font: "Inter", -apple-system, BlinkMacSystemFont, "Segoe UI", sans-serif

- Modern, highly readable, excellent for UI
- Weights needed: 400, 500, 600, 700

- Import from Google Fonts: `https://fonts.googleapis.com/css2?family=Inter:wght@400;500;600;700&display=swap`

Monospace Font (optional, for code/technical values): `"JetBrains Mono", "Fira Code", monospace`

- Used for timestamps, IDs, technical values
- Weights: 400, 600

Type Scale

Element	Font Size	Font Weight	Line Height	Letter Spacing	Usage	Example
Page Title	32px	700	1.2	-0.01em	Main page headings	"Research Workspace"
Section Title	20px	600	1.3	0	Section headings	"What should we decode today?"
Card Title	16px	600	1.4	0	Card/modal titles	"Market Analysis Results"
Body	14px	400	1.6	0	Paragraph text, descriptions	Form helper text
Small	13px	400	1.5	0	Secondary text, meta	"2 min ago"
Tiny	12px	500	1.4	0.02em	Labels, badges	"RECENT RESEARCH"
Code	13px	400	1.5	0	Code blocks, technical values	Timestamps, IDs

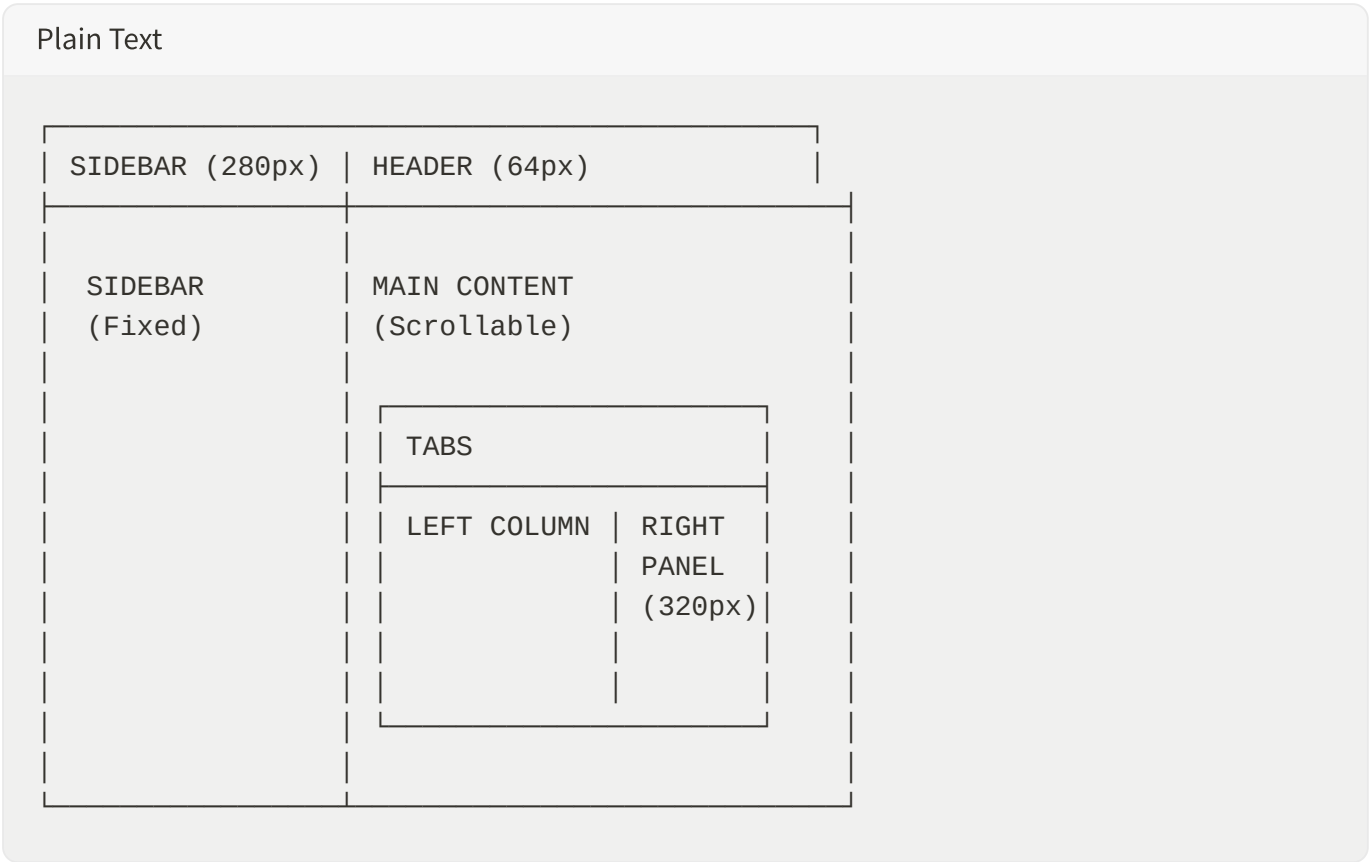
Text Colors

- **Primary Text:** `var(--text-primary)` - All main content
- **Secondary Text:** `var(--text-secondary)` - Labels, descriptions, secondary info
- **Tertiary Text:** `var(--text-tertiary)` - Disabled, muted, placeholder text
- **Accent Text:** `var(--accent)` - Interactive elements, links, highlights

Layout Architecture

Overall Structure

The Brief app uses a **3-section grid layout**:



Grid Dimensions

Section	Width	Height	Position	Behavior
Sidebar	280px	100vh	Fixed, left	Scrollable content

Header	Remaining	64px	Sticky, top	Stays visible on scroll
Main Content	Remaining	Flexible	Relative	Scrollable
Right Panel	320px	Flexible	Relative	Scrollable with content

Container Widths

- **Sidebar:** 280px (fixed)
- **Header:** Full width minus sidebar (280px)
- **Main Content:** Full width minus sidebar
- **Right Panel:** 320px (optional, collapsible on mobile)
- **Content Max Width:** 1600px (prevents excessive line length)
- **Gutter/Padding:** 24px (standard), 16px (compact), 32px (spacious)

Component Library

1. Sidebar Component

Container Properties:

- Width: 280px (fixed)
- Height: 100vh (full viewport height)
- Background: `var(--bg-primary)`
- Border-right: 1px solid `var(--border)`
- Position: Fixed, left: 0, top: 0
- Display: Flex, flex-direction: column
- Overflow-y: Auto (scrollable)
- Overflow-x: Hidden
- Z-index: 20

Sidebar Header:

- Height: 64px
- Padding: 16px

- Border-bottom: 1px solid `var(--border)`
- Display: Flex, gap: 8px, align-items: center
- Position: Sticky, top: 0
- Background: `var(--bg-primary)`
- Z-index: 10

Logo Icon:

- Width: 32px, Height: 32px
- Background: `var(--accent)`
- Border-radius: 8px
- Display: Flex, align-items: center, justify-content: center
- Color: White
- Font-weight: 700, Font-size: 16px
- Flex-shrink: 0

Logo Text:

- Font-size: 16px, Font-weight: 700
- Color: `var(--text-primary)`

Primary Action Button:

- Width: `calc(100% - 32px)` (280px - 16px padding on each side)
- Margin: 16px
- Padding: 12px 16px
- Background: `var(--accent)`
- Color: White
- Border: None
- Border-radius: 8px
- Font-size: 14px, Font-weight: 600
- Cursor: Pointer
- Transition: all 200ms ease
- Hover: Background `#6d28d9` (darker purple)

Navigation Section:

- Margin-top: 24px

Section Label:

- Padding: 8px 16px
- Font-size: 11px, Font-weight: 600, Text-transform: uppercase
- Color: var(--text-tertiary)
- Letter-spacing: 0.05em

Navigation Item:

- Padding: 12px 16px
- Margin: 4px 8px
- Border-radius: 8px
- Font-size: 14px, Font-weight: 400
- Color: var(--text-secondary)
- Cursor: Pointer
- Transition: all 200ms ease
- Display: Flex, gap: 12px, align-items: center
- Overflow: hidden, Text-overflow: ellipsis, White-space: nowrap

Nav Item States:

State	Background	Text Color	Border-left	Padding-left
Default	Transparent	var(--text-secondary)	None	16px
Hover	var(--bg-surface-hover)	var(--text-primary)	None	16px
Active	var(--accent-subtle)	var(--accent)	2px solid var(--accent)	14px

Nav Icon:

- Width: 20px, Height: 20px
- Flex-shrink: 0
- Opacity: 0.7 (default), 1 (active/hover)

Recent Items Section:

- Margin-top: 32px

- Flex: 1 (takes remaining space)
- Overflow-y: Auto (scrollable)

Recent Item:

- Padding: 10px 16px
 - Margin: 4px 8px
 - Border-radius: 6px
 - Font-size: 13px, Font-weight: 400
 - Color: `var(--text-secondary)`
 - Cursor: Pointer
 - Transition: all 200ms ease
 - Overflow: hidden, Text-overflow: ellipsis, White-space: nowrap
 - Hover: Background `var(--bg-surface-hover)` , color `var(--text-primary)`
-

2. Header Component

Container Properties:

- Height: 64px
- Background: `var(--bg-primary)`
- Border-bottom: 1px solid `var(--border)`
- Display: Flex, align-items: center, justify-content: space-between
- Padding: 0 24px
- Position: Sticky, top: 0
- Z-index: 30
- Margin-left: 280px (accounts for fixed sidebar)

Header Layout:

- Left Section: Flex 1, justify-content: flex-start
- Center Section: Flex 1, justify-content: center
- Right Section: Flex 1, justify-content: flex-end

Breadcrumb:

- Font-size: 14px, Font-weight: 400
- Color: `var(--text-secondary)`

- Display: Flex, gap: 8px, align-items: center

Breadcrumb Separator:

- Content: "/"
- Margin: 0 4px
- Color: `var(--text-tertiary)`

Current Page Title:

- Font-size: 16px, Font-weight: 600
- Color: `var(--text-primary)`

Search Bar:

- Width: 320px
- Padding: 8px 12px
- Background: `var(--bg-surface)`
- Border: 1px solid `var(--border)`
- Border-radius: 8px
- Font-size: 14px, Font-weight: 400
- Color: `var(--text-primary)`
- Placeholder-color: `var(--text-tertiary)`
- Transition: all 200ms ease

Search Bar Focus State:

- Border-color: `var(--accent)`
- Box-shadow: 0 0 0 3px `rgba(124, 58, 237, 0.1)`
- Outline: None

Icon Button:

- Width: 40px, Height: 40px
- Border-radius: 8px
- Background: Transparent
- Border: None
- Color: `var(--text-secondary)`
- Cursor: Pointer
- Display: Flex, align-items: center, justify-content: center

- Transition: all 200ms ease
- Font-size: 18px
- Hover: Background `var(--bg-surface-hover)` , color `var(--text-primary)`

User Avatar:

- Width: 36px, Height: 36px
 - Border-radius: 50%
 - Background: `var(--accent)`
 - Color: White
 - Display: Flex, align-items: center, justify-content: center
 - Font-weight: 600, Font-size: 14px
 - Cursor: Pointer
-

3. Main Content Area

Container Properties:

- Margin-left: 280px (sidebar width)
- Margin-top: 64px (header height)
- Padding: 32px 24px
- Min-height: $\text{calc}(100\text{vh} - 64\text{px})$
- Background: `var(--bg-primary)`
- Overflow-y: Auto

Content Grid:

- Display: Grid
 - Grid-template-columns: 1fr 320px (or 1fr if no right panel)
 - Gap: 24px
 - Max-width: 1600px
 - Margin: 0 auto
-

4. Tab Navigation Component

Container:

- Display: Flex

- Border-bottom: 1px solid var(--border)
- Background: var(--bg-surface)
- Padding: 0 24px
- Margin-bottom: 24px
- Border-radius: 12px 12px 0 0
- Overflow-x: Auto
- Overflow-y: Hidden

Tab Item:

- Padding: 12px 16px
- Font-size: 14px, Font-weight: 500
- Color: var(--text-secondary)
- Border-bottom: 2px solid transparent
- Cursor: Pointer
- Transition: all 200ms ease
- White-space: Nowrap
- Position: Relative

Tab Item States:

State	Color	Border-bottom
Default	var(--text-secondary)	Transparent
Hover	var(--text-primary)	1px solid var(--border)
Active	var(--accent)	2px solid var(--accent)

5. Card Component (Unified)

Base Card:

- Background: var(--bg-surface)
- Border: 1px solid var(--border)
- Border-radius: 12px
- Padding: 20px

- Transition: all 200ms ease

Card States:

State	Background	Border	Box-shadow
Default	<code>var(--bg-surface)</code>	<code>var(--border)</code>	None
Hover	<code>var(--bg-surface-hover)</code>	<code>#4a4a5e</code>	<code>0 4px 12px rgba(0, 0, 0, 0.2)</code>
Active	<code>var(--bg-surface)</code>	<code>var(--accent)</code>	<code>0 0 0 2px rgba(124, 58, 237, 0.2)</code>
Disabled	<code>var(--bg-primary)</code>	<code>var(--border)</code>	None

Card Header:

- Display: Flex, justify-content: space-between, align-items: flex-start
- Margin-bottom: 16px
- Padding-bottom: 16px
- Border-bottom: 1px solid `var(--border)`

Card Title:

- Font-size: 16px, Font-weight: 600
- Color: `var(--text-primary)`

Card Subtitle:

- Font-size: 13px, Font-weight: 400
- Color: `var(--text-secondary)`
- Margin-top: 4px

Card Body:

- Font-size: 14px, Font-weight: 400
- Color: `var(--text-secondary)`
- Line-height: 1.6

Card Footer:

- Display: Flex, justify-content: space-between, align-items: center
- Margin-top: 16px

- Padding-top: 16px
- Border-top: 1px solid var(--border)

6. List Component (Unified - Replaces Repetitive Items)

Container:

- Display: Flex, flex-direction: column
- Gap: 8px
- Background: var(--bg-surface)
- Border-radius: 12px
- Padding: 8px
- Border: 1px solid var(--border)

List Item:

- Padding: 12px 16px
- Border-radius: 8px
- Display: Flex, justify-content: space-between, align-items: center
- Cursor: Pointer
- Transition: all 200ms ease
- Background: Transparent
- Border: None

List Item States:

State	Background	Text Color
Default	Transparent	var(--text-secondary)
Hover	var(--bg-surface-hover)	var(--text-primary)
Active	var(--accent-subtle)	var(--accent)

List Item Content:

- Display: Flex, flex-direction: column, gap: 4px
- Flex: 1

List Item Title:

- Font-size: 14px, Font-weight: 500
- Color: Inherit from parent state

List Item Subtitle:

- Font-size: 12px, Font-weight: 400
- Color: `var(--text-tertiary)`

List Item Meta:

- Display: Flex, gap: 12px, align-items: center
 - Font-size: 12px, Font-weight: 400
 - Color: `var(--text-tertiary)`
-

7. Badge Component

Base Badge:

- Display: Inline-flex, align-items: center, gap: 6px
- Padding: 6px 12px
- Border-radius: 6px
- Font-size: 12px, Font-weight: 500
- White-space: Nowrap

Badge Variants:

Variant	Background	Text Color	Usage
Default	<code>var(--border)</code>	<code>var(--text-secondary)</code>	Generic labels
Primary	<code>var(--accent-subtle)</code>	<code>var(--accent)</code>	Active, important
Success	<code>rgba(74, 222, 128, 0.15)</code>	<code>var(--success)</code>	Completed, success
Warning	<code>rgba(250, 204, 21, 0.15)</code>	<code>var(--warning)</code>	Pending, caution
Error	<code>rgba(239, 68, 68, 0.15)</code>	<code>var(--error)</code>	Error, failed

8. Form Components

Form Group:

- Margin-bottom: 16px

Form Label:

- Display: Block
- Font-size: 13px, Font-weight: 500
- Color: var(--text-primary)
- Margin-bottom: 6px

Form Input (Text, Select, Textarea):

- Width: 100%
- Padding: 10px 12px
- Font-size: 14px, Font-weight: 400
- Background: var(--bg-primary)
- Border: 1px solid var(--border)
- Border-radius: 8px
- Color: var(--text-primary)
- Placeholder-color: var(--text-tertiary)
- Transition: all 200ms ease

Input States:

State	Background	Border	Box-shadow
Default	var(--bg-primary)	var(--border)	None
Focus	var(--bg-primary)	var(--accent)	0 0 0 3px rgba(124, 58, 237, 0.1)
Hover	#11111f	#4a4a5e	None
Disabled	#11111f	var(--border)	None
Error	var(--bg-primary)	var(--error)	0 0 0 3px rgba(239, 68, 68, 0.1)

Form Helper Text:

- Font-size: 12px, Font-weight: 400
- Color: var(--text-secondary)

- Margin-top: 4px

Error Text:

- Font-size: 12px, Font-weight: 400
 - Color: `var(--error)`
 - Margin-top: 4px
-

9. Button Component

Base Button:

- Padding: 10px 16px
- Font-size: 14px, Font-weight: 600
- Border-radius: 8px
- Border: None
- Cursor: Pointer
- Transition: all 200ms ease
- Display: Inline-flex, align-items: center, justify-content: center, gap: 8px

Button Variants:

Primary Button:

- Background: `var(--accent)`
- Color: White
- Hover: Background `#6d28d9` , box-shadow `0 4px 12px rgba(124, 58, 237, 0.3)`
- Active: Background `#5b21b6`
- Disabled: Background `var(--border)` , color `var(--text-tertiary)` , cursor not-allowed

Secondary Button:

- Background: `var(--bg-surface)`
- Border: 1px solid `var(--border)`
- Color: `var(--text-primary)`
- Hover: Background `var(--bg-surface-hover)` , border-color `#4a4a5e`
- Active: Background `#19192d`
- Disabled: Color `var(--text-tertiary)` , border-color `var(--border)` , cursor not-allowed

Ghost Button:

- Background: Transparent
- Border: None
- Color: `var(--text-secondary)`
- Hover: Background `var(--bg-surface-hover)` , color `var(--text-primary)`
- Active: Background `#19192d`
- Disabled: Color `var(--text-tertiary)` , cursor not-allowed

Danger Button:

- Background: `var(--error)`
- Color: White
- Hover: Background `#dc2626` , box-shadow `0 4px 12px rgba(239, 68, 68, 0.3)`
- Active: Background `#b91c1c`
- Disabled: Background `var(--border)` , color `var(--text-tertiary)` , cursor not-allowed

Button Sizes:

Size	Padding	Font-size	Height
Small	8px 12px	12px	32px
Medium	10px 16px	14px	40px
Large	12px 20px	16px	48px

10. Modal/Dialog Component

Overlay:

- Position: Fixed, inset: 0
- Background: `rgba(0, 0, 0, 0.6)`
- Backdrop-filter: `blur(4px)`
- Z-index: 50
- Display: Flex, align-items: center, justify-content: center

Modal Container:

- Background: `var(--bg-surface)`
- Border: 1px solid `var(--border)`

- Border-radius: 12px
- Width: 90vw, max-width: 600px
- Max-height: 90vh
- Overflow-y: Auto
- Box-shadow: 0 20px 60px rgba(0, 0, 0, 0.4)

Modal Header:

- Padding: 24px
- Border-bottom: 1px solid var(--border)
- Display: Flex, justify-content: space-between, align-items: center

Modal Title:

- Font-size: 20px, Font-weight: 600
- Color: var(--text-primary)

Modal Close Button:

- Width: 40px, Height: 40px
- Background: Transparent
- Border: None
- Color: var(--text-secondary)
- Cursor: Pointer
- Display: Flex, align-items: center, justify-content: center
- Transition: all 200ms ease
- Hover: Color var(--text-primary) , background var(--bg-surface-hover)

Modal Body:

- Padding: 24px

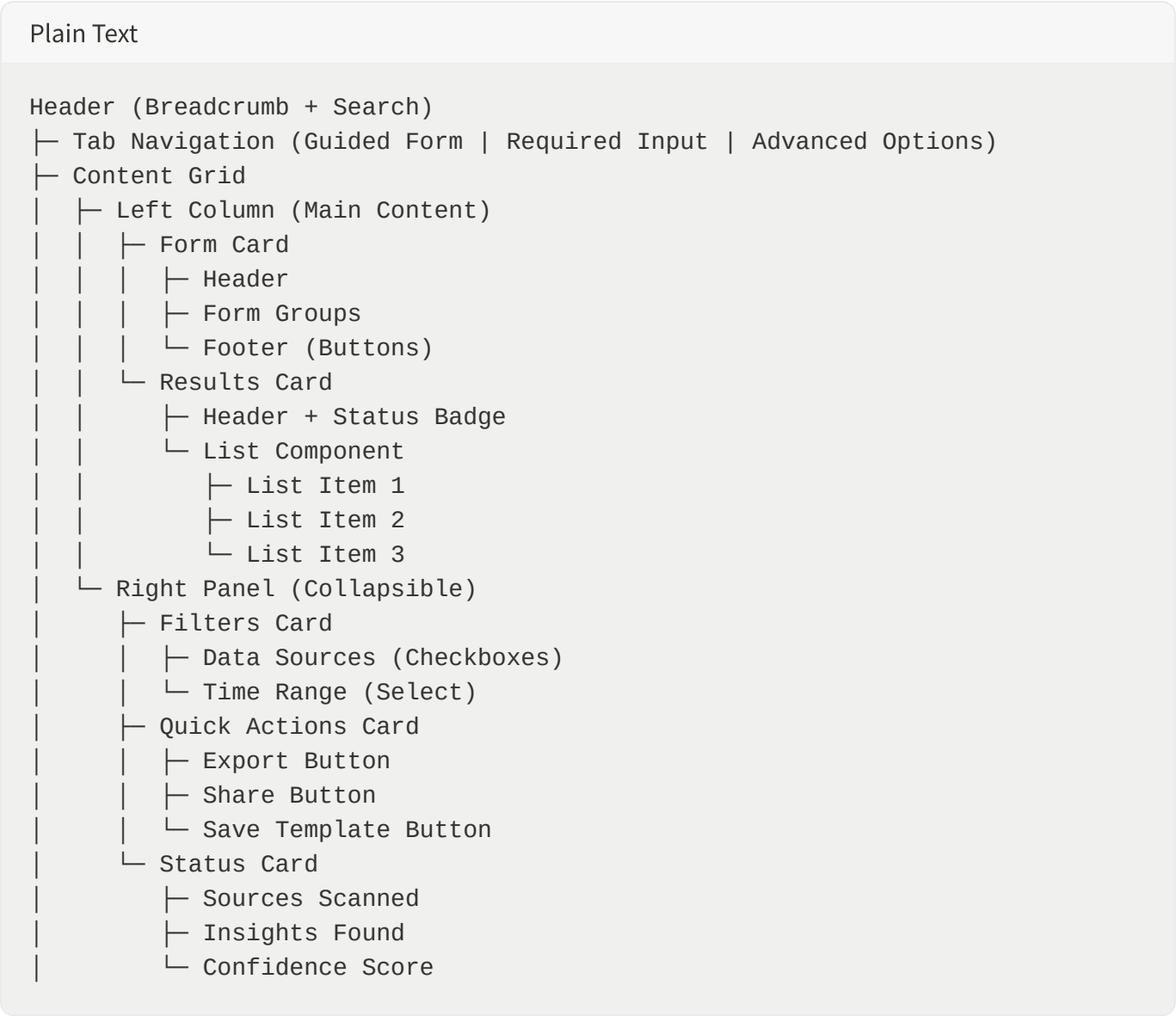
Modal Footer:

- Padding: 24px
- Border-top: 1px solid var(--border)
- Display: Flex, justify-content: flex-end, gap: 12px

Page Layouts

Research Workspace Page

Page Structure:



Key Measurements:

- Left Column: Flexible (1fr)
- Right Panel: 320px (fixed)
- Gap between columns: 24px
- Form Card Padding: 20px
- Form Group Margin: 16px
- List Item Padding: 12px 16px
- List Item Gap: 8px

Spacing & Grid

Spacing Scale (4px Base Unit)

All spacing follows the 4px grid:

Plain Text	
4px	= 1 unit
8px	= 2 units
12px	= 3 units
16px	= 4 units
24px	= 6 units
32px	= 8 units
48px	= 12 units
64px	= 16 units
96px	= 24 units

Standard Spacing Rules

Element	Spacing	Usage
Page padding	32px	Main content area
Section gap	24px	Between major sections
Card padding	20px	Inside cards
Form group margin	16px	Between form fields
Element gap	12px	Between inline elements
List item gap	8px	Between list items
Component margin	24px	Between cards/sections

Padding Consistency

- **Large containers:** 32px
- **Cards:** 20px
- **List items:** 12px 16px (vertical, horizontal)
- **Form inputs:** 10px 12px

- **Buttons:** 10px 16px
 - **Badges:** 6px 12px
-

Interactions & States

Hover States

All interactive elements have consistent 200ms ease transitions:

CSS

```
transition: all 200ms ease;
```

Hover Effects:

- **Cards:** Background lightens, border brightens, shadow appears
- **Buttons:** Background darkens/lightens, shadow appears (primary only)
- **List Items:** Background lightens, text brightens
- **Nav Items:** Background lightens, text brightens
- **Inputs:** Border color changes, shadow appears on focus

Focus States

All focusable elements show clear focus indicators:

- **Focus Outline:** 2px solid `var(--accent)` or box-shadow
- **Box-shadow:** 0 0 0 3px `rgba(124, 58, 237, 0.1)`
- **Outline:** None (use box-shadow instead)

Active States

- **Active Tab:** Border-bottom `2px solid var(--accent)` , text color `var(--accent)`
- **Active Nav Item:** Background `var(--accent-subtle)` , text color `var(--accent)` , left border `2px solid var(--accent)`
- **Active List Item:** Background `var(--accent-subtle)` , text color `var(--accent)`
- **Active Card:** Border `1px solid var(--accent)` , box-shadow `0 0 0 2px rgba(124, 58, 237, 0.2)`

Disabled States

- **Disabled Button:** Background `var(--border)` , text color `var(--text-tertiary)` , cursor not-allowed
- **Disabled Input:** Background `#11111f` , border `var(--border)` , text color `var(--text-tertiary)`
- **Disabled Text:** Color `var(--text-tertiary)` , opacity 0.5

Loading States

- **Loading Spinner:** Subtle, no bounce
- **Skeleton Loaders:** Use `var(--bg-surface-hover)` with pulse animation
- **Loading Text:** "Loading..." with ellipsis animation

Responsive Design

Breakpoints

Breakpoint	Width	Layout
Mobile	< 768px	Sidebar hidden, full-width content
Tablet	768px - 1200px	Sidebar collapsed, content adjusts
Desktop	> 1200px	Full layout with right panel visible

Mobile Adjustments (< 768px)

- **Sidebar:** Hidden (hamburger menu instead)
- **Header:** Simplified, no center search
- **Main Content:** Full width, padding 16px
- **Right Panel:** Bottom drawer or hidden
- **Font Sizes:** Reduced by 1px
- **Spacing:** Reduced by 4px
- **Grid:** Single column layout

Tablet Adjustments (768px - 1200px)

- **Sidebar:** Collapsed or hidden
- **Header:** Full width
- **Main Content:** Full width with adjusted padding
- **Right Panel:** Hidden or bottom drawer
- **Grid:** 2 columns (if right panel visible)

Desktop Adjustments (> 1200px)

- **Sidebar:** Full width (280px)
 - **Header:** Adjusted for sidebar
 - **Main Content:** Full layout
 - **Right Panel:** Visible (320px)
 - **Grid:** 2 columns (main + right panel)
-

Transitions & Motion

Transition Rules

No flashy animations. Only functional, subtle transitions:

- **Hover states:** 200ms ease
- **State changes:** 150ms ease
- **Modal open/close:** 300ms ease
- **Scroll animations:** None (instant)
- **Loading states:** Subtle pulse (no bounce)

CSS Transition Template:

CSS

```
transition: all 200ms ease;  
/* Or specific properties: */  
transition: background-color 200ms ease, border-color 200ms ease;
```

Animation Principles

1. **Functional Only:** Animations serve a purpose (feedback, guidance)
2. **Subtle:** Animations are understated, not distracting

3. **Fast:** All transitions complete within 300ms
 4. **Consistent:** Same animation timing across all elements
-

Accessibility Guidelines

Color Contrast (WCAG Compliance)

- **Text Primary on Background:** 12:1 (exceeds WCAG AAA)
- **Text Secondary on Background:** 8:1 (meets WCAG AA)
- **Accent on Background:** 8:1 (meets WCAG AA)
- **Borders on Background:** 4:1 (meets WCAG AA)

Keyboard Navigation

- **Tab Order:** Follows visual flow (left to right, top to bottom)
- **Focus Indicators:** Always visible, 2px solid accent color
- **Escape Key:** Closes modals and dropdowns
- **Enter Key:** Submits forms, activates buttons

Screen Reader Support

- **Semantic HTML:** Use `<header>` , `<nav>` , `<main>` , `<section>` , `<footer>`
- **ARIA Labels:** For icon buttons, use `aria-label`
- **Form Labels:** Always associated with inputs using `<label for="id">`
- **Live Regions:** Use `aria-live="polite"` for status updates

Motion Preferences

Respect `prefers-reduced-motion` media query:

CSS

```
@media (prefers-reduced-motion: reduce) {  
  * {  
    animation-duration: 0.01ms !important;  
    animation-iteration-count: 1 !important;  
    transition-duration: 0.01ms !important;  
  }  
}
```

Implementation Checklist

Phase 1: Setup & Structure

- ☐ Create React/Next.js project
- ☐ Set up Tailwind CSS with custom color tokens
- ☐ Create CSS variables for all colors
- ☐ Import Inter font from Google Fonts
- ☐ Set up project folder structure
- ☐ Create base layout (sidebar, header, main content)

Phase 2: Core Components

- ☐ Build Sidebar component
- ☐ Build Header component
- ☐ Build Card component
- ☐ Build List component
- ☐ Build Tab Navigation component
- ☐ Build Badge component
- ☐ Build Button component
- ☐ Build Form components (Input, Label, Helper)

Phase 3: Page Layouts

- ☐ Build Research Workspace page
- ☐ Integrate all components
- ☐ Add tab navigation functionality
- ☐ Add form handling
- ☐ Add list interactions

Phase 4: Polish & Refinement

- ☐ Test all hover/focus/active states

- ☐ Verify color contrast ratios
- ☐ Test keyboard navigation
- ☐ Test responsive design on all breakpoints
- ☐ Add loading states
- ☐ Add error states
- ☐ Optimize performance

Phase 5: Accessibility & Testing

- ☐ Test with screen reader
- ☐ Verify WCAG AA compliance
- ☐ Test with keyboard only
- ☐ Test on mobile devices
- ☐ Cross-browser testing
- ☐ Performance testing

Quick Reference: Color Hex Values

Plain Text	
Primary Background:	#0f0f1e
Surface:	#1a1a2e
Surface Hover:	#242438
Border:	#353549
Text Primary:	#f5f5ff
Text Secondary:	#b8b8d0
Text Tertiary:	#8888a0
Accent:	#7c3aed
Success:	#4ade80
Warning:	#facc15
Error:	#ef4444
Info:	#3b82f6

Quick Reference: Component Sizes

Plain Text

Sidebar Width:	280px
Header Height:	64px
Right Panel Width:	320px
Card Border Radius:	12px
Button Border Radius:	8px
Input Border Radius:	8px
Badge Border Radius:	6px
Logo Icon Size:	32px
Avatar Size:	36px
Icon Button Size:	40px

Quick Reference: Spacing

Plain Text

Page Padding:	32px
Section Gap:	24px
Card Padding:	20px
Form Group Margin:	16px
Element Gap:	12px
List Item Gap:	8px
List Item Padding:	12px 16px
Form Input Padding:	10px 12px
Button Padding:	10px 16px
Badge Padding:	6px 12px

Quick Reference: Typography

Plain Text

Page Title:	32px / 700 / 1.2
Section Title:	20px / 600 / 1.3
Card Title:	16px / 600 / 1.4
Body:	14px / 400 / 1.6
Small:	13px / 400 / 1.5
Tiny:	12px / 500 / 1.4
Code:	13px / 400 / 1.5

Support & Questions

For implementation questions or clarifications, refer to the component specifications above. Each component includes:

1. Container properties
2. Child element specifications
3. State variations
4. Sizing and spacing
5. Color tokens
6. Transition rules

All measurements are in pixels (px) unless otherwise specified.

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